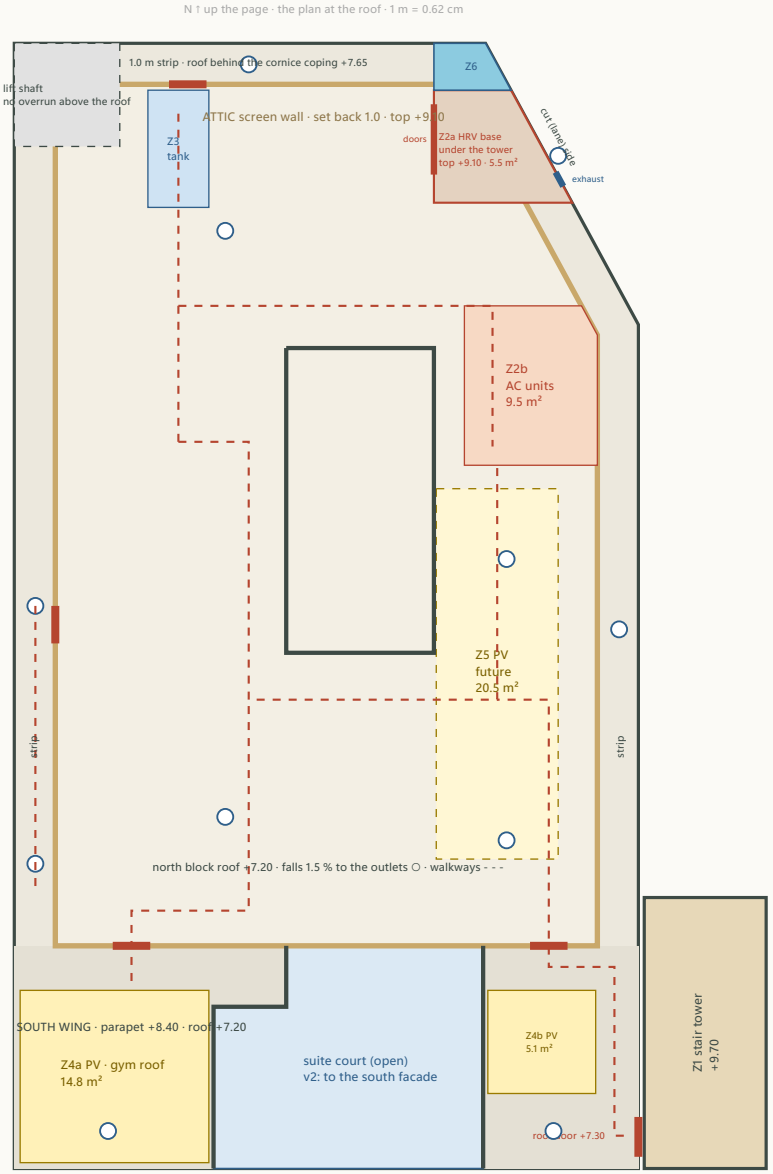
Roof study · the stair to the roof, the set-back attic, the main cornice, the reserved zones · Taif / Palm House V7.1

Design review F-07 (major) · owner decisions 31 Oct 2026 · flat roof, no tiles · the roof for maintenance and equipment only · no slab level changes · all sizes assumed until the engineer and the suppliers confirm



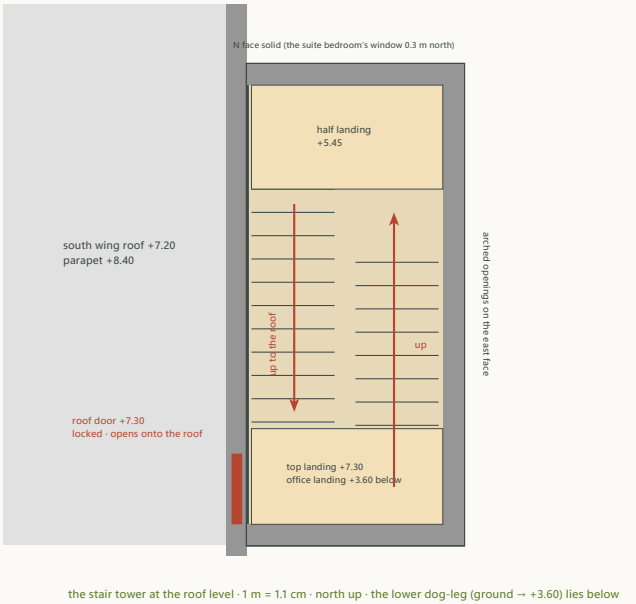
1 · Roof plan: what is on the roof

- **Access (1 Nov 2026):** from the **external stair tower Z1** at the south-east (outside the east wall): its roof door at +7.30 in the south wing parapet (y 22.9–23.75, locked; a locked gate below it above the office landing; no door from the roof into the house). The main stair stops at the first floor and the roof slab over its well is closed. The lift stops at the first floor; its shaft needs no head above the roof (§ 5).
- **Attic:** a screen wall 1.8 m high (top +9.10 with its coping) set back 1 m from the facade face on the north, the cut (lane), the east and the west sides (a plain pentagon since the stair room went); its south wall stands on the y 19.25 line (beams B8 / R5). Length ≈ 57.7 m. Two doors in it to the strip (north, west) and one to the south wing.
- **The 1.0 m strip** (Z7) in front of the attic: roof behind the main cornice and its low coping, with its own outlets.
- **South wing** (y 19.25–24): the main cornice and a plain parapet to +8.40 the roofline steps 0.7 m down from the attic coping, and the parapet stands on the facade while the attic is 1.0 m back.
- **Guards:** a black steel bar guard 1.10 m round the courtyard sky hole (19.3 m) and on the suite court's west (gym roof and nib) and east (office roof) edges; its north edge is the attic wall, its south edge the parapet on the facade frame R8 (v2).
- **Drains:** 11 roof outlets to internal downpipes in the walls (no scuppers through the cornice); falls 1.5 % away from the holes and the attic walls; the strip falls along the facade to its outlets; overflow spouts in the strip's upstand.
- **Walkways:** 0.9 m wide on paving pads from the stair tower's roof door west along the south wing (south of the suite court's guards: no opening crossed), then (v2) north along the office roof to a new attic door at x 11.0–11.8 on y 19.25 into the north block and on to the tank, the PV, the condensers and the HRV base; the gym roof from the north block through the attic door at x 2.1–2.9; no opening crossed (the court lies between the two south wing roofs), no walking on the insulation.

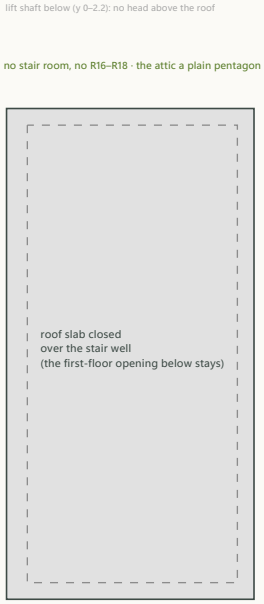
Zone	m²	Note
Z1 the external stair tower (SE, outside the east wall)	15	1 Nov 2026 (studies/south_wing.typ): the roof is reached from the stair tower x 13.436–16.036, y 18.22–24.0, top +9.70 its roof door at +7.30 through the south wing parapet (y 22.9–23.75, locked, no door into the house); the internal stair stops at the first floor, the roof slab over the well closed
Z2a the HRV base under the tower	5.5	`studies/air_system.typ` v3.1 (owner): the tower rises from a base housing the ventilation unit (one mass): top +9.10 = the attic coping, 1.65 m clear inside (a low service compartment: the unit ≈ 110 kg on a plinth right behind a pair of doors 1.5 m high on its west face, filters and the core pulled from the roof terrace, no entry); the intake duct drops inside the tower's compartment; the exhaust louvre on the cut face
Z2b plant: AC outdoor units	9.5	behind the cut / east attic wall, SOUTH of the tower and its base (owner): 2.2 m clear of the base's south wall, 5.15 m south of the intake louvre in plan, so the tower never takes their hot air; over the suite bath (anti-vibration mounts); 0.6 m service space round each unit
Z3 water tank(s)	3.3	≈ 2 × 1.5 m³ between the roof beams R10 and R3, inside the attic (needed only if the owner wants a gravity reserve)
Z4 PV, south wing (gym roof Z4a + office roof Z4b)	19.9	v2: west and east of the court, never in front of the clerestory windows; fixing points cast in before waterproofing
Z5 PV, future (north block east)	20.5	inside the attic; morning shade from the east attic wall
Z6 malqaf head	1.4	the tower rises to +9.80: the one element above the attic, by design; v3: a four-sided head, the breeze shaft and the ventilation intake compartment inside (`studies/air_system.typ`)
Z7 the 1.0 m strip in front of the attic	40.6	roof behind the main cornice and its coping; falls to its own outlets; reached through two doors in the attic wall

Areas on wall centre lines / zone outlines. PV: ≈ 7.4 + 10.3 panels of 2 m² (≈ 7.4 kWp at 420 W each) if both zones are used.

The roof access since 1 Nov 2026 · the main stair stops at the first floor · the external stair tower at the south-east reaches the office landing and the roof



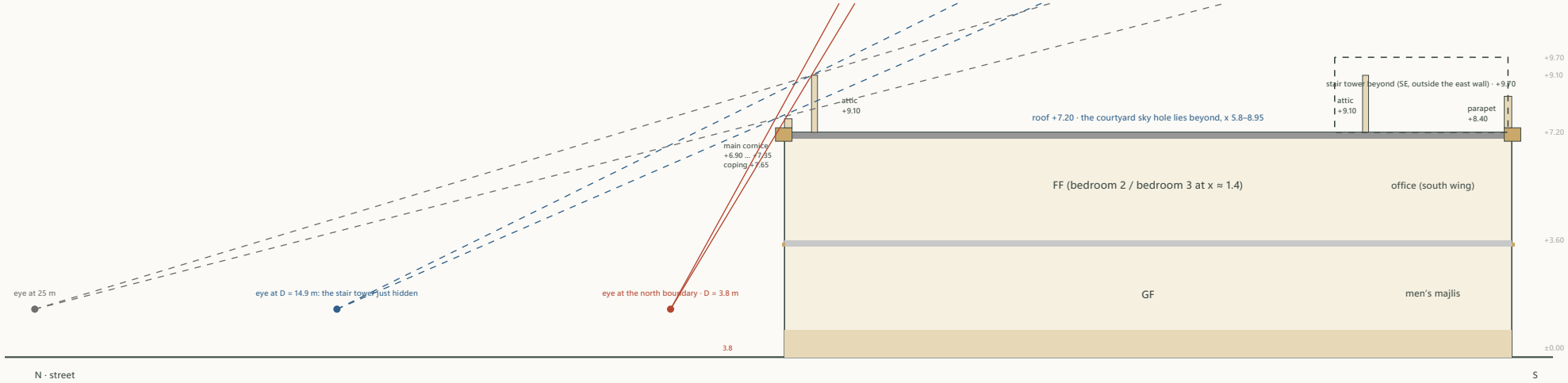
the stair tower at the roof level · 1 m = 1.1 cm · north up · the lower dog-leg (ground → +3.60) lies below



2 · The roof access

- **Owner's decision (1 Nov 2026, studies/south_wing.typ):** the roof is reached from the **external stair tower** at the south-east corner, outside the east wall (x 13.436–16.036, y 18.22–24.0 on its outer faces, 2.6 × 5.78): a dog-leg stair of 23 risers (× 0.170, goings 0.28, flights 1.0 m clear) from the ground (−0.30) to the office landing (+3.60, the visitors' door into the office) and 22 risers on to the roof (+7.30); headroom ≥ 3.5 m over every flight (the flight above is one storey up); the roof door in the south wing parapet at y 22.9–23.75, opening onto the roof; a locked gate across the stair above the office landing; the gate at the foot locked against entry and opening outwards without a key. Visitors and workers never enter the house; no door from the roof into the house.
- **The internal stair stops at the first floor:** flights 3 and 4, the roof stair room (V7.0, x 0–2.75, y 2.2–7.9, +9.70) and the roof opening over the well are dropped; the roof slab over the well is an ordinary bay (no trimmers R16–R18); the first-floor stair and its opening do not change. The attic becomes a plain pentagon set back 1.0 m on all four sides; the north-west corner of the roofline loses its +9.70 element; the stair tower (+9.60) stands at the south-east, so the lane front carries the two verticals (the malqaf +9.80 at the north-east, the tower at the south-east).
- **Composition:** the tower in the design language (cream plaster, a honey-stone plinth and arch surrounds, two arched openings per storey on its east and south faces, the main cornice line carried round it, a stone coping), top +9.70: above the south wing parapet (+8.40) and the attic coping (+9.10), below the malqaf head (+9.80).
- **Walkways:** from the roof door west along the south wing (the walkway y 22.6, south of the suite court's guards: no opening crossed), through the attic door at y 19.25 into the north block, then to the tank (Z3), the PV (Z4 / Z5), the condensers (Z2b) and the HRV base (Z2a); 0.9 m on paving pads, never on the insulation.
- **Lift:** no change to the shaft (2.25 × 2.2, placeholder) and no overrun above the roof: see § 5. **3D:** the model still builds the V7.0 roof stair and stair room until the next build (`docs/PENDING_CHANGES.md`).

Sight lines · north–south section through the stair room (x ≈ 1.4), looking west · the attic 1.8 m set back 1 m · eye 1.6 m above the ground



3 · What the attic hides, and from where

The eye is 1.6 m above the ground outside (+1.30 against the house's ±0.00; the ground assumed at −0.30). An object behind the facade is hidden when its top lies below the line from the eye over the screen in front of it (the cornice coping +7.65 on the facade, or the attic coping +9.10 1 m behind it).

Observer (north street)	cornice	attic	stair tower (SE)
north boundary (street), NW corner	59.1°	58.4° (hidden)	54.3° hidden
north street, 10 m from the facade	32.4°	35.3°	34.5° hidden
north street, the limit	23°	26.1°	26.1° hidden
north street, 25 m (the far side)	14.3°	16.7°	17.1° **shows**

Angles above the horizon from the eye. The stair room's north face is 2.23 m behind the north facade face, its top +9.70. From the lane boundary (D = 2.5 m) the AC units (1.2 m, 2.0 m behind the cut facade) are seen at 57.6° against the attic's 65.8°: hidden; and from any distance, since 1.2 < 1.8. From the east boundary (D = 3.6 m) the plant zone is likewise hidden. The malqaf head (+9.80, on the facade in the cut tip) is the one element above the attic, by design.

- **Attic height 1.8 m:** set in V7.0 by the stair room; kept (1 Nov 2026): it hides the plant, the tank and the condensers from the street and the lane at every distance, and the external stair tower (top +9.70, 2.2 m behind the north facade) stays hidden from the north street up to 14.9 m.
- **Since 1 Nov 2026 nothing stands above the attic on the north block except the malqaf and its base:** the stair room is gone; the stair tower rises outside the east wall at the south-east, 0.6 m above the attic coping and 0.1 m below the malqaf, seen from the lane and the south garden by design.

4 · The courtyard's sky and sun with the attic

From every point of the courtyard floor the attic walls and the stair room lie **below the hole's own edges** (the roof edge beams at +7.20), so they take nothing from the sky the courtyard sees today (enclosure study: 7.2 % of the hemisphere from the floor's middle, unchanged):

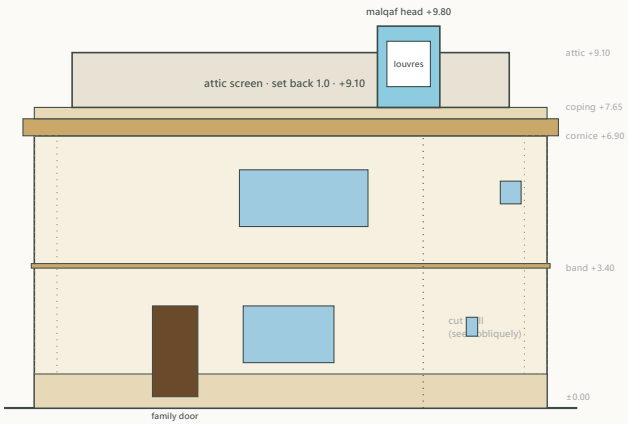
From the far edge of the floor	hole edge	attic / stair room
attic south wall (y 19.25, +9.10) from the floor's north edge (y 6.6)	48.4°	35.7° ✓
attic north wall (y 0.875) from the floor's south edge (y 12.9)	48.4°	37.1° ✓
attic east wall (x 12.436) from the floor's west edge (x 4.35)	58°	48.4° ✓

- **Winter noon sun** (45.2°, the light check): the ray that just clears the hole's south edge (+7.20 at y 13.0) passes the attic's south wall line (y 19.25) at +13.49, far above its coping +9.10: the attic never shades the courtyard, in any season. The clerestory windows sit in the y 19.25 wall itself, below the attic wall: unchanged; their sun comes over the gym roof edge (X4), which stays a railing.
- **The suite court** gets the attic's south wall on its north side (its shaded side): no loss of sun, a little less sky.

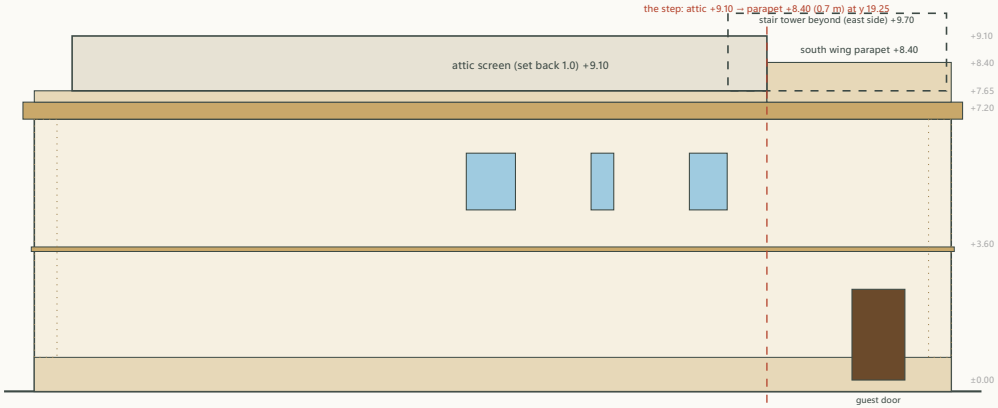
5 · The lift

- Top stop at the first floor (+3.60); the roof slab underside at +7.00: **3.4 m headroom available**. A typical Saudi villa lift (machine-room-less traction, 400–630 kg, 2 stops) asks 3.4–3.6 m headroom above the top floor and a 1.2–1.4 m pit (assumed from supplier catalogues; open item 14 asks for the drawings); a platform home lift (EN 81-41) asks 2.3–2.6 m.
- **So:** choose a lift with headroom ≤ 3.4 m: no shaft head above the roof. If the chosen lift needs up to 3.85 m, a raised shaft head of ≤ 0.45 m (top +7.65) stays hidden behind the main cornice coping; more than that is not possible: the shaft (x 0–2.25, y 0–2.2) lies in the 1.0 m strip in front of the attic, not inside it. **No conflict** with the stair room (it starts at y 2.2, the shaft's south wall). Added to open item 14 as a requirement for the supplier.

North and west elevations · simple line drawings · the main cornice, the thin cornice between the floors, the set-back attic, the stepped roofline · openings indicative



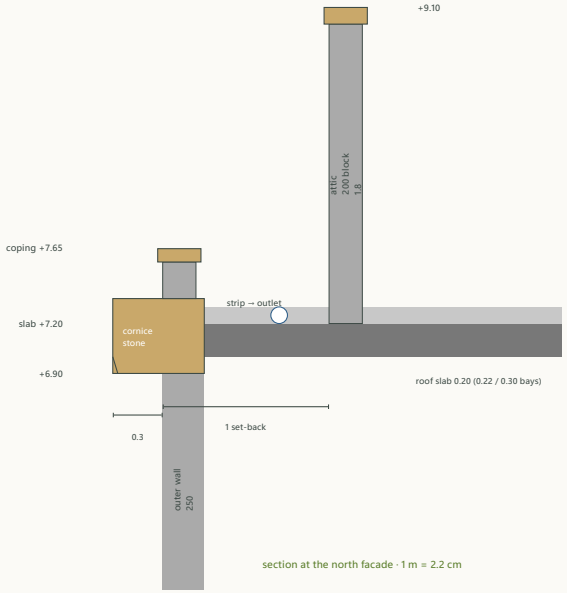
NORTH ELEVATION (from the street) · W ← → E · 1 m = 0.5 cm



WEST ELEVATION (from the M line / the neighbour) · N ← → S · 1 m = 0.5 cm

Cream plaster, honey stone at the plinth (to +0.60), the corners (quoins, dotted), the thin band at the first-floor slab (0.12 m, projecting 0.08) and the main cornice (0.45 m high, projecting 0.3, +6.90 … +7.35); the attic and the stair room plastered cream with stone copings. The south elevation repeats the west one's south part (parapet +8.40); the east elevation the north block's coping and attic (set back 1.0) over the kitchen / suite windows, then the parapet. Openings are indicative here: the real ones are in the plans and the studies.

The cornice and the attic in section · loads for the engineer · what changes in the files



6 · Sizes (assumed, by this study)

- **Main cornice:** honey stone, 0.45 m high (+6.90 … +7.35), projecting 0.3 m with a drip, on the facade edge all round the house; above it a 0.30 m upstand with a stone coping to **+7.65** on the north block (the strip's parapet) and the plain parapet to **+8.40** on the south wing. The thin cornice between the floors: a stone band 0.12 m high at +3.40, projecting 0.08.
- **Attic:** 200 mm block, plastered cream, stone coping; 1.8 m above the roof slab (coping +9.10); set back 1 m from the facade face (0.88 m from the wall centre lines); ≈ 57.7 m long; on the south on the y 19.25 line (B8 / R5). Three doors (two to the strip, one to the south wing).
- **Roofline step:** 0.7 m at y 19.25 (attic coping +9.10 → parapet +8.40), plus the 1.0 m plan set-back.
- **Stair tower (external, SE; 1 Nov 2026):** 2.6 × 5.78 on its outer faces outside the east wall (y 18.22–24.0), two dog-leg flights to the office landing (+3.60) and two to the roof (+7.30), top +9.70: 2.5 m above the roof slab, 0.6 m above the attic coping, 0.1 m below the malqaf head; arched openings east and south, the north face solid (the suite bedroom's window is 0.3 m north of it).

7 · Loads for the engineer (assumed)

- **Attic walls:** 200 block 1.8 m + coping ≈ 4.5 kN/m, standing on the roof slab 0.88 m inside the outer-wall beams (R7 / R8, the cut and east wall beams): near the supports, but a line load on the slab: thicken the slab edge or add a small hidden beam under it; the south attic wall on R5 / B8.
- **Stair tower:** on its own footings beside the east strip footing, tied or jointed to the house (the engineer); the roof door through the parapet; no load on the roof slab. The roof slab over the stair well is an ordinary bay now (no trimmers).
- **Cornice:** stone ≈ 2.5 kN/m hung on the slab edge (anchored precast or cut stone); parapets 1.1 m ≈ 2.8 kN/m; the thin band 0.3 kN/m.
- **Plant:** 3–4 AC outdoor units ≈ 1.0 kN each and the ERV ≈ 1.5 kN on pads with anti-vibration mounts (local ≈ 1.5 kN/m²); **tank(s):** up to 3 m³ = 30 kN on ≈ 3.3 m² (≈ 9 kN/m²) on the R10–R3 bay (1.5 m span): to be checked; **PV:** ≈ 0.25 kN/m² plus wind uplift (ballast or cast-in fixing points, 24 m² now, 20 m² future); **malqaf head** as the air study; walkway pads 0.5 kN/m².
- **Roof live load** for maintenance only: 1.0–1.5 kN/m² (SBC 301, the engineer).

8 · Conflicts and open points

- **Stair tower vs the roofline** (§ 3): the tower's top +9.70 stands outside the east wall at the south-east, above the south wing parapet and the attic, below the malqaf: two verticals on the lane side, by design (owner, 1 Nov 2026).
- **Lift** (§ 5): no overrun if the supplier's headroom is ≤ 3.4 m (≤ 3.85 m with a 0.30 m raised head behind the cornice): a requirement for open item 14.
- **Courtyard light** (§ 4): none lost.
- **First-floor layout** (§ 2): nothing lost.
- **3D and the plans:** the roof opening, the stair room, the attic, the cornice and the parapets are not yet in `3d/params.yaml` / `build_3d.py` (the builder has no attic or cornice yet) nor in the presentation: PENDING_CHANGES.md.

9 · What this study changes in the files

- `studies/structure.typ`: R16–R18 and the stair-well voids dropped (1 Nov 2026), X16 superseded; the stair tower on its own footings (engineer); `studies/fire_escape.typ`: the tower counted as the first floor's second way out with conditions; `3d/params.yaml`: the roof stair data stays until the next 3D build.
- `docs/DESIGN_LANGUAGE.md`: flat roof, no tiles, the main cornice, the set-back attic on the north block, the south wing parapet.
- `data/decisions.csv`: roof access by the main stair; the roofline. Open item 14: the lift headroom requirement (`docs/PENDING_CHANGES.md`).

Study checks passed (12)